

Word family: **exterior / exteriors / exteriorly**

Base word: exterior

Plural: exteriors

Related form: exteriorly (rare)

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective (形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “It is large, modern, and full of clean lines, with a glass **exterior** that allows a lot of natural light to come in.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **exterior** means the **outside surface or outer part of a building**.

繁體中文： **外部；外表面；建築物的外牆或外觀部分**

中文翻譯：

> “...with a glass **exterior**...”

「.....配有玻璃**外牆 / 外部表面**.....」

Here:

glass exterior = 以玻璃構成的建築外部 / 外牆

1. **exterior = outside surface or outer part (外部) — 外部；外表面**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: The outside part or surface of a building, object, vehicle, etc.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The building has a glass **exterior**.”

「這棟建築有玻璃**外牆 / 外部表面**。」

Practice 2

> “The car’s **exterior** was badly scratched.”

「汽車的**外部表面**被嚴重刮花。」

Practice 3

> “The house has a simple **exterior**.”

「這間屋的**外觀 / 外部**很簡潔。」

****exterior = 某個建築物、物件或車輛最外面的部分****

Common:

- * building exterior
- * car exterior
- * exterior wall
- * exterior surface

2. ****exterior = outward appearance (外表) — 外表 ; 表面形象****

****Exterior**** can also mean the outward appearance someone or something presents.

Practice 4

> “His calm ****exterior**** hid his nervousness.”

「他平靜的****外表****掩飾了內心的緊張。」

Practice 5

> “Beneath her confident ****exterior****, she was uncertain.”

「在她自信的****外表****之下，其實她並不確定。」

****exterior = 人或事物表面呈現出來的外在形象****

This is a figurative extension of the physical outside.

3. ****exterior = outside area of something (外面區域) — 外圍 ; 外部區域****

In more formal or technical contexts, ****exterior**** can refer to the outer region of something rather than just the visible surface.

Practice 6

> “The damage was limited to the **exterior** of the structure.”

「損壞只限於建築結構的**外部**。」

Practice 7

> “The spacecraft’s **exterior** must withstand extreme temperatures.”

「太空船的**外部**必須承受極端溫度。」

exterior = 某事物最外圍、外層或外部範圍

For strict counting, I would merge this with Meaning 1.

4. **exterior** = adjective: on the outside (形容詞) — 外部的；外面的

As an adjective, **exterior** means located on or relating to the outside.

Practice 8

> “The **exterior** walls were painted white.”

「**外牆**被漆成白色。」

Practice 9

> “The building needs **exterior** repairs.”

「這棟建築需要進行**外部維修**。」

exterior = 位於外部、關於外部的

Common:

- * exterior wall
- * exterior door
- * exterior paint
- * exterior design

This is the adjective counterpart of Meaning 1.

5. **exterior** = outward, not inner/internal (抽象對比) — 外在的 ; 表面的

In formal language, **exterior** can contrast with internal or inner qualities.

Practice 10

> “The problem is not merely **exterior**.”

「這個問題不只是**外在的 / 表面的**。」

This use exists, but it is less common in everyday English.

For learner priority, I would keep it as a lower-frequency abstract extension rather than a core sense.

Related form: **exteriorly**

Exteriorly means on the outside or outwardly.

Practice 11

> “The building was **exteriorly** restored.”

「這棟建築的**外部**經過修復。」

This word is valid but quite rare.

In most modern English, people would simply say:

> on the outside

> externally

So I would treat **exteriorly** as low priority.

Important distinction: **exterior** vs **outside**

outside

is the everyday general word.

exterior

is more formal and often refers specifically to the outer surface or design of a building/object.

- > outside of the building
- > building exterior

Both can refer to the same area, but **exterior** sounds more architectural/technical.

Important distinction: **exterior vs external**

exterior

usually refers to the physical outside or visible outer surface.

external

is broader and often means originating from outside or located outside a system/body.

- > exterior wall
- > external pressure
- > external source

So they overlap, but **external** has more abstract uses.

Important distinction: **exterior vs facade**

facade

usually means the front face of a building, especially its architectural front.

exterior

means the outside of the whole building.

So:

- > facade = 正面外牆
- > exterior = 整體外部

Important distinction: **exterior vs appearance**

appearance

is very broad and means how something looks.

exterior

emphasizes the outside surface or outward presentation.

> attractive appearance

> stone exterior

Not interchangeable in all contexts.

Important distinction: **exterior vs surface**

surface

means the outermost layer of almost anything.

exterior

usually refers to the outside of a whole object/building/vehicle.

> surface of the table

> exterior of the car

Important distinction: **exterior vs interior**

This is the core contrast.

exterior

= outside

interior

= inside

> exterior walls

> interior walls

- > exterior design
- > interior design

Countability note

As a noun, **exterior** is countable when referring to separate outer designs/surfaces:

- > different exteriors

But more commonly it appears as:

- > the exterior of the building

As an adjective:

- > exterior wall
- > exterior paint

countability does not apply.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family is quite small:

- * **exterior**
- * **exteriors**
- * **exteriorly** (rare)

Most modern uses share the same core concept:

- > **the outside or outward-facing part of something**

The figurative “calm exterior” use is a useful extension because it shifts from physical surface to outward appearance.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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exterior — physical outside	建築物、物件或車輛最外面的部分 / 表面
exterior — outward appearance	人或事物表面呈現出來的外在形象
exterior — adjective	位於外部或與外部有關的

| **exterior** — abstract outward side | 外在的、表面的；較正式、低頻 |
| **exteriorly** | 在外部；向外；較少見 |

For your original sentence

> “...with a glass **exterior** that allows a lot of natural light to come in.”

The exact meaning is:

exterior = 建築物最外面的結構與表面

So:

> **a glass exterior**

= **玻璃外牆 / 玻璃外部結構**

For your database, I would count **2 genuinely useful core meanings** for **exterior**:

1. **physical outside / outer surface**
2. **outward appearance, especially figurative “calm exterior”**

I would treat adjectival **exterior** as the same core family meaning, and keep abstract/formal uses as lower-priority extensions rather than inflate the count.